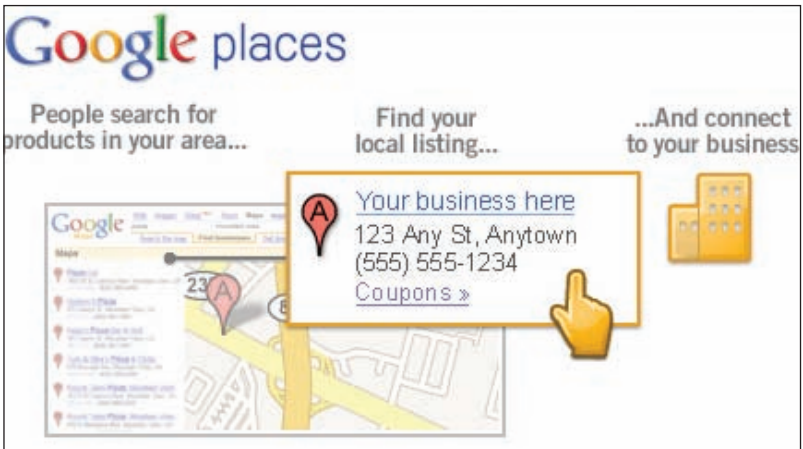


search engine crawler from your home page to every page in your site. Although highly unlikely, another thing to ensure is that you don't use frames for navigation menus. Creating sitemaps is more important than you would imagine. Sitemaps help both search engines and visitors get to things easily. There are certain free sitemap generators available out there such as www.xml-sitemaps.com.

Now that you know what to do to tweak your site for search engines, it's time to know how to measure the effectiveness of the steps you've taken. A free tool called www.webposition.com can help you a lot in this regard. The tool allows you to check your websites current ranking, and compare it against other keyword competitors.

6.5.2 Increase Local internet appeal



Google local

When you start off most likely you will learn to exploit your local network to get business. The same can be done in the online world. Lots of people search for businesses locally online. To cater to them you need to follow a few simple guidelines. On every page of your website, in the footer section you can enter the local address such as the road name or locality name and even pin code. Get listed in directory listing websites like sulekha or any other web yellow pages. Also create a free listing for your local business on Google Maps Local Business Center (www.google.com/local/add) Use Google Places to create your free listing.

When potential customers search Maps for local information, they'll find your business: your address, hours of operation, offers etc. The same